Nhill 2.1 — User guide

Français : ../fr/guide-utilisateur.md

Part	Application	For	Platforms
A	**Nhill Business**	the business: sales, customers, stock, purchases, expenses, reports, team	Windows, Linux, Android
B	**Nhill Console**	the creators of Nhill (private application)	Windows, Linux
C	**Nhill POS**	the cashiers of a business	Windows, Linux

Screenshots: `docs/captures/` (taken on version 0.1.0; the 2.0 screens keep the same layout, with the improvements listed in § 0). The applications are available in French and English; the labels below are the English ones.

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0. What is new for users

Version 2.1

- **Remember me** (Nhill Business and Nhill POS, on Windows, Linux and Android): when ticked at sign-in, the application reopens already signed in. Only a session token is kept, in the system's secure storage (Windows Credential Manager, Android Keystore, Linux keyring), **never the password**. Unticked, nothing is kept; signing out also erases the remembered session (§ 10).
- **Forgotten password**: the establishment's administrator gives an employee a temporary password; owners and administrators receive a code by e-mail (§ 9).

Version 2.0

- **Passwords**: at least 8 characters everywhere (account creation, invitation, password change, reset, administration console). Very common passwords ("12345678", "password", "kinshasa"…) are refused. No periodic change is required; change it only if you think it was seen or guessed.
- **Show password**: an eye button in every password field shows or hides what you type (useful on phones).
- **Windows that fit the screen**: on start, each application takes a size suited to the screen (small laptop screens included) and is centred; on a screen that is too small it opens maximised. Windows can be resized freely.
- **Tables**: horizontal scrolling when the columns do not fit, tooltip on truncated text, keyboard navigation (arrows, Enter).
- **Accessibility**: stronger contrast (secondary text, field borders, disabled buttons), visible keyboard focus ring, tooltips on icon buttons, error messages shown longer (8 s) and announced to screen readers.
- **Nhill POS**: `F2` puts the cursor in the search / barcode field, `F9` opens payment; − / + buttons for quantities; layout adapted to narrow screens; closing requires the counted amount.

Part A — Nhill Business

1. First start

The **Welcome** screen offers two choices.

1.1 “My business already exists” (join)

1. Enter the **establishment code** (`NH-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX`) given by the owner. The code changes automatically every 30 days: if it is refused, ask for the new one. The error message is deliberately the same in every case.
2. The code is not enough: either **“I have an account”** (your e-mail and password) or **“I received an invitation”** (the invitation e-mail, the 8-digit activation code given by your manager, and a password of at least 8 characters that you choose).

1.2 “Create my business”

1. **Type of activity**: *Sole trader* (one user, simplified screens) or *Company or organisation* (several users, roles, invitations).
2. **Identity**: trade name, legal name, sector, country, VAT registration, legal identifiers (RCCM, national ID, tax number… only those that apply to you).
3. **Contact details and preferences**: city, address, phone, e-mail, main currency, document language.
4. **Your account** (owner, password of at least 8 characters), then **review and create**.

The free trial (30 days by default) starts without any payment method. Write down the **establishment code** shown at the end. If a business with the same legal identifier already exists, Nhill never links you to it automatically: you can send a **link request**, checked by the owner or by support.

2. Main screen

Side menu (drawer on phones, scrollable when the window is short): Dashboard, Sales, Customers and suppliers, Products and services, Stock, Purchases, Expenses, Payments, Reports, Activity log (or My activity), Settings. At the top: global search (`Ctrl+K`), connection status (Online / Offline / Server problem), subscription status, notifications.

Shortcut	Action
`Ctrl+K`	global search
`Ctrl+N`	new invoice (if your role allows it)
`Ctrl+1` … `Ctrl+4`	Dashboard, Sales, Customers, Products
`F5`	refresh the screen
`Alt+←` (Back key)	previous screen
`Tab` / `Shift+Tab`	next / previous field (also inside text areas)

Light, dark or automatic theme and language (French/English): Settings › My account.

3. Sales

- **New invoice** (or quote, order): customer, currency, date, due date, lines (product or free line, quantity, price before tax, discount, tax). The total shown is an estimate; the server recalculates and its figure is authoritative.
- **Save draft**: editable, no number, “DRAFT” watermark on the PDF.
- **Issue**: the invoice gets its **final number** (e.g. `FA-2026-000012`), stock goes down, and it **can no longer be edited or deleted**. To correct it: **Credit note** (full or partial, with optional return to stock).
- **Foreign-currency document**: an exchange rate is asked for at issue; it is stored with its date and source and never recalculated.

- **Connection lost while issuing or recording a payment**: a banner offers **Retry**. The operation will never be recorded twice.
- **Quote**: Send → Accepted / Declined → Convert to invoice. **Order**: Confirm → Convert to invoice.
- **Payment**: from the invoice, "Record a payment" (cash, Mobile Money, card, transfer, cheque..., reference). The amount cannot exceed the balance due.
- **PDF**: PDF button; the file is saved in `Downloads/Nhill` and opened.
- **DRC, VAT-registered**: Nhill documents are **management documents**, not standardised invoices. Issue the standardised invoice with the electronic tax device required by the DGI, then use "Record DEF reference" on the Nhill invoice for reconciliation (see `docs/en/legal-parameters.md`).

4. Customers, products, stock, purchases, expenses

- **Customers and suppliers**: contact details, tax number, payment terms, internal notes; the record shows the balance and documents.
- **Products and services**: reference, name, unit, sale and purchase price, tax, alert threshold. CSV import/export (`;`): import is **all or nothing** (errors are listed per line and nothing is imported while any remain).
- **Stock**: quantities change **only through movements** (sale, purchase, credit note, adjustment with a mandatory reason, transfer between warehouses depending on the plan). Movements tab: full history with the author.
- **Purchases**: draft → **Receive goods** (stock in, purchase price updated) → payment.
- **Expenses**: amount including tax, deductible tax, category, supplier, paid or not, **receipt** (PDF/PNG/JPEG, 5 MB).

5. Reports

Sales journal (with "Issued by"), activity per employee, payments (with "Recorded by"), expenses, sales per product (margin **estimated** at the current purchase price), stock movements, receivables and payables to date. Any period, export to **CSV** or **PDF**. Amounts are always shown **per currency**, never converted or added across currencies.

6. Who did what — activity log

- **Owner, administrator, accountant**: *Activity log* — every action in the business (sign-ins, documents, payments, stock, products, contacts, team, settings, till, Nhill support interventions), with date, author, object and details. Filters by **employee**, **action type** (including "Till" and "Nhill support" in 2.0) and **period**; **CSV/PDF** export. Clicking a line opens the document concerned.
- **"Activity per employee" report**: for each person and currency, documents created, invoices and credit notes issued, amounts collected, expenses entered, stock corrections and last activity.
- **Other roles**: *My activity* — only their own actions.
- The log is kept by the server and **can be neither edited nor erased**, not even by the owner. Tell your staff about it.

7. Settings

Tab	Content	Who
Business	Identity, legal identifiers, **logo**, document language, payment terms, tax rounding, payment instructions, footer, negative stock	Owner, administrator

Tab	Content	Who
Establishment code	Show/hide, copy, **renew now**	Owner, administrator, manager (read)
Team	Members, roles, deactivation, **invitations** (activation code shown **only once**: hand it over in person, by phone or SMS), **password reset** of a member (§ 9)	Owner, administrator
Subscription	Plan, end date, plans by duration and currency, promo code, payment, history	Owner, administrator
Taxes and accounts	Tax rates (cannot be edited: create a new code), cash and bank accounts, **exchange rates**	Owner, administrator
Point of sale	Tills and cashiers, payment methods, maximum discount, receipt, till promo codes, sessions and X/Z reports	Owner, administrator; manager and accountant: sessions and reports
My account	Name, phone, language, theme, **password** (changing it signs out your other devices), **Remember me on this device**, sign out	Everyone

Roles: **Owner**, **Administrator**, **Manager**, **Sales / cashier**, **Accountant**, **Till supervisor**, **Cashier**, **Read only**.

8. Subscription (owner and administrators)

- Free trial (30 days by default, once per business).
- **Choose a plan**: duration and currency offered by Nhill, then **Choose this plan**. The summary computed by the server shows the price, any discount, the prorated credit and the total.
- **Upgrade**: immediate, unused part deducted. **Downgrade**: applied at the end of the period. **Renewal**: no day is lost.
- **Payment**: card or PayPal when Nhill has enabled them, otherwise bank transfer / Mobile Money with the reference shown, confirmed by the billing team. The subscription changes when the payment is confirmed, never before. An unpaid request expires after 48 hours.
- After the grace period without payment: **read only** (viewing and export remain possible).

9. Help and support

Help and support menu: send a question or a bug report to the Nhill team and follow the answers. Never include a password, an establishment code or a card number.

Forgotten password

The Nhill team does not know your password and will never ask for it. Depending on your role:

You are an employee (sales, cashier, accountant, manager…). Ask the administrator or the owner of your establishment. In **Settings › Team**, they choose your name, then **Reset the password**: Nhill creates a temporary password (12 characters, for example `k7Rm-x2Qa-Hp9w`), shown **only once**, which they give you **in person or by phone** (never by e-mail or in a group chat). Your open sessions are closed immediately. At your next sign-in with this temporary password, Nhill asks you to choose a new one (at least 8 characters, different from the temporary one) before opening the application. The temporary password expires after 72 hours: after that, ask for another one.

An administrator can only reset accounts of **their** establishment, never the owner's nor their own; only the owner can reset an administrator. If your account is also used in **another** business, none of its administrators can reset it: use the e-mail procedure below.

You are the owner or an administrator (or your account is used in several businesses). On the sign-in screen, choose **Forgot your password?**, enter your e-mail address, then **Send the code**. You receive an 8-digit code (`1234-5678`), valid for **20 minutes** and usable **once**; enter it with your new password. After 5 wrong codes the code is cancelled: ask for a new one. A new request cancels the previous code. The message shown is the same whether or not the address matches an account (so nobody can find out who uses Nhill); if yours is an employee account, the e-mail you receive tells you whom to contact. Once the password is changed, **all your sessions are closed** and an e-mail informs you of the change.

Changing your password while signed in remains possible (Settings › My account).

10. Sign-in and security

- **Remember me**: tick it at sign-in, only on a device you do not share. The application then reopens signed in; the session token is kept in the system's secure storage (Windows Credential Manager, Android Keystore, Secret Service or KWallet keyring on Linux), never in plain text and never the password. **Signing out** erases this session; unticking the option (at sign-in or in Settings › My account) erases it too. If the system refuses to keep it (for example Linux without a keyring), the application says so and will ask you to sign in again.
- Lost or stolen device: change your password from another device (every other session is closed) or ask your administrator to reset your access.
- Offline: viewing and writing are suspended; nothing is lost.
- Several businesses with the same account: choose at sign-in.
- After several wrong sign-in attempts, the server slows further attempts down.

Part B — Nhill Console (creators)

Separate application, reserved for the creators of Nhill. Every action is written to the audit log. The console gives **no access to the invoices, customers or stock** of the businesses.

1. Access

- **Install a new server** (once): see the installation guide § 4.
- **First access**: e-mail, **initialisation token** (valid 30 minutes), password of **at least 8 characters**, then add the key to an authenticator app (TOTP) and enter a 6-digit code. Two-factor authentication remains **mandatory** for the console (it gives access to the whole platform); a long passphrase is recommended.
- **Sign-in**: e-mail + password + TOTP code (each code works once). The session is not remembered.
- Roles: **superadmin**, **billing** (plans, payments, reports), **support** (businesses, suspensions, codes, link requests, announcements), **auditor** (read only: log, statistics, provider events).

2. Screens

Screen	Use
Overview	Businesses, subscriptions by state, active users, 30-day activity, confirmed revenue
Businesses	Search; record: identity, subscription, codes (without their value), statistics; **Suspend / Reactivate / Reissue code**, **Subscription…** — reason required
Reports	Global report per business and currency — CSV/PDF
Link requests	Check identity, accept/decline with a note

Screen	Use
Notifications	Support, payments received or mismatched, technical errors
Support requests	Take, answer, internal note, change state
Transactions	Payment requests, reconciliation, **manual confirmation** of a transfer (reference + reason)
Plans and prices	Plans, limits and **prices per duration and currency** (no hard-coded price)
Promo codes	Percentage or amount, dates, uses, eligible plans
Payment providers	Stripe, PayPal, Payoneer (configuration only), generic; secrets **encrypted, never shown again**; test/production mode
Technical errors	Grouped errors, to mark as resolved
Audit log	Platform and security events
Announcements	Messages to businesses
Platform settings	Trial, grace, code rotation, limits; invite an administrator

A business's **statistics** are aggregates computed by the database; no customer name, product or document number is transmitted, and every view appears in the business's log.

Part C — Nhill POS (till)

Linked to a Nhill Business establishment: same products, prices, taxes and stock. Each cashier signs in with **their own account** (Cashier or Till supervisor role).

1. Prepare (Nhill Business → Settings → Point of sale)

1. **New till**: code printed on receipts (e.g. `C1`), name, location, warehouse.
2. **Who can open this till**: tick the cashiers.
3. **Payment methods**: Cash (automatic), Card, M-Pesa… Nhill records the amount; it does not drive card terminals or mobile operators.
4. **Rules and receipt**: maximum discount without approval, width (58/80 mm), message.
5. **Till promo codes**.

2. Open the till

Sign in, choose the till, **count the opening float**, **Open the session**. "Remember me" and "Forgot your password?" work as in Nhill Business (Part A, § 9 and § 10); on a till computer shared by several cashiers, leave "Remember me" unticked.

3. Sell

Key / button	Action
`F2`	go to search / barcode
Enter (after a barcode)	add the product
− / +	decrease / increase a line's quantity

Key / button	Action
`%`	line discount
`F9` or **Pay**	open payment

- One or several payment methods; for cash, enter the **amount tendered**: the change is shown. **Print the receipt** (roll-format PDF).
- Above the allowed discount, a supervisor enters **their own** e-mail and password; the approval works once and is logged.
- Network cut during validation: press Validate again; the sale will not be recorded twice.
- Narrow screen: the ticket moves below the product grid.

4. Receipts, returns, cancellations, cash

Receipts and till: list of the session's receipts ("Date / time" column), totals, sales per payment method.

- On a receipt: **Print**, **Return quantities** or **Cancel the receipt** (same session). Reason required; supervisor approval if needed.
- **Cash in / out**; cash out cannot exceed the cash present.
- **X reading**: interim report without closing.

5. Close

Close the till: count the drawer (amount **required**) and enter the terminal totals. The cashier does not see the expected amount; the server computes the difference. The **Z report** can then be downloaded; a closed session can no longer be changed. Differences are notified to supervisors.

Receipts are management documents; Nhill POS is not a certified till.